

62 Possibility

Modal verbs can be used to talk about possibility, or to express uncertainty. "Might" is the most common modal verb used for this purpose.

See also:

Present simple **1** Infinitives and participles **51**
Modal verbs **56**

62.1 "MIGHT" FOR POSSIBILITY

"Might" can be added to different phrases to refer to past, present, or future possibilities.

PAST POSSIBILITY

"MIGHT" + "HAVE" + PAST PARTICIPLE

I can't find the compass. I **might have dropped** it earlier.



PRESENT POSSIBILITY

"MIGHT" + BASE FORM

I don't remember this path. We **might be** lost.



FUTURE POSSIBILITY

"MIGHT" + "BASE FORM" + FUTURE TIME

It's very cold outside. It **might snow** later on.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

We **might have taken** a wrong turn at the river.



It **might be** windy at the top of the mountain.



"Not" always comes after
"might" to form the negative.

Joe **might not come** walking with us next weekend.



TIP

Questions with "might" are only used in very formal English.